

4, Islam Is a Religion Exceptionally Suited for Early Feudal Societies

On today's internet, Islam is frequently depicted as an intensely aggressive religion, sparking widespread apprehension. While this perspective indeed reflects a certain historical reality, it actively conceals another, vastly more crucial historical truth.

Is Islam's capacity for expansion formidable? Undoubtedly, yes. From Senegambia all the way to the East Indies, the fact that a single religion conquered such a vast swathe of territory over a millennium—even massively rolling back the spheres of influence of Christianity and Buddhism—would undeniably leave a profound impression on any observer.

However, on the flip side, we must acutely note that Islam's expansion possessed an extremely clear "boundary": **This religion was only ever capable of conquering societies in *pre-feudalized* (前封建的) regions; when faced with societies that had already undergone *feudalization* (封建化), it was utterly powerless!**

If we meticulously catalogue the enemies Islam conquered, it is effortlessly apparent that they were essentially either untamed lands in the *pre-state society* (前国家社会), *early slavery states* (奴隶制的早期国家), or *classical empires* (古典帝国). Yet, when confronting truly *feudalized* enemies, let alone scoring victories, Islam was frequently and massively repelled.

First, let us observe the northeastern frontier of the Islamic map. While Muslims were conquering Central Asia, the Xinjiang region of present-day China was still under the control of the Tang Empire—a *restoration-bureaucratic state* (复辟官僚帝国). The city-states of the Xinjiang region were light-years away from *feudalization*; hence, Islam conquered the region and massively infiltrated the Chinese interior during the Yuan Dynasty.

However, as the Mongols embraced Tibetan Buddhism and underwent preliminary *feudalization*, by the 17th century, the Islamic forces in the Xinjiang region were actually overwhelmed by the Dzungar Khanate (准噶尔汗国), which practiced Tibetan Buddhism! Ironically, it was the Great Qing Emperor who ultimately lifted this mountainous burden off the heads of Xinjiang's Muslims. *(Even despite such retardation, the Islamization of northwestern China during the Ming and Qing dynasties was staggeringly severe).*

On the northern frontier of the Islamic map, the Islamic khanates in the central and western Eurasian Steppe were drastically beaten back to the Caucasus by the expansion of a *feudalized* Russia. The Islamic states that once stretched from the Southern Russian steppes to the shores of the Black Sea simply ceased to exist.

In Hindustan (印度斯坦), Islamic regimes did indeed come close to controlling the entire subcontinent. Yet, the current political map is extraordinarily fascinating.

The Indus River Valley, where Pakistan is located, shares a remarkably similar environment with the primary terrain of the Afro-Asian Islamic world. This tropical desert climate, predicated on large-river irrigation agriculture, is indeed exceedingly difficult to *feudalize*. When Turkic Muslims invaded, the region was indeed in a *pre-feudalized* state.

When the Ghurid dynasty (古尔王朝) first invaded what is now the territorial scope of Bangladesh, it was still considered the "frontier" of India—a watery expanse of swamps compared to the fully developed majority of the Ganges Basin. *(This phrasing might be slightly excessive, but the*

historical progression of the Bengal region—including both East and West Bengal—was indeed centuries behind the Ganges Plain, making its relative social backwardness entirely normal. I will mention this region again later).

When Muslims first arrived in Kashmir (克什米尔), the Tibetan Empire (吐蕃帝国) ruling the Qinghai-Tibet Plateau had only recently collapsed. But as the Qinghai-Tibet Plateau underwent **feudalization**, Islam could not advance half an inch further eastward onto the plateau!

The rulers of the Shah dynasty in Nepal, nestled at the southern foothills of the Himalayas, were originally Hindus from northern India who refused to submit to Islam. They clearly forged an ironclad defensive perimeter in this mountainous nation that was undergoing its **feudal period**, and Muslims never set foot there.

When the Turks entered northern India, although the **feudalization** of northern India should have theoretically begun, its degree was extremely low, allowing Muslims to swiftly sweep across the region. But simultaneously, the feudal process in southern India was still vigorously underway, boasting a multitude of Hindu **feudal** kingdoms and even empires like Vijayanagara (毗奢耶那伽罗). Undoubtedly, when Muslim rulers cast their gaze southward, they discovered that conquering the region was harder than scaling the heavens. Neither the Delhi Sultanate nor the Mughal Emperors could ever completely crush the resistance at the southern tip of the subcontinent.

If one argues that the political independence of southern India from the north was primarily driven by geopolitical factors, then clearly, what drove such ferocious *religious* resistance must be their **social being** (社会存在)!

Because one easily notes that regimes centered in northern India found it equally difficult to govern Bengal, yet this did not prevent Bangladesh from maintaining its identity as an Islamic nation even after independence.

Furthermore, as the feudal process in northern India developed further, Muslim rule in the north faced formidable challenges. The most classic example is the Sikhs (锡克教徒) in Punjab; the Muslims' holy war against them ended in catastrophic defeat. To this day, with northern and southern India unified under a single regime, it remains a regional power with Hinduism as its absolute core.

Further to the southeast, the situation was identical. The Maldives, Malaya, and the East Indies were populated by **pre-state societies**, **early slavery states**, and **pseudo-classical empires** (伪古典帝国) like Majapahit (满者伯夷). Without a shred of suspense, they were conquered by Islam. On the island of Java, Islamic expansion was even realized through localized Islamization sparking devastating rebellions.

However, in Sri Lanka, which practiced Theravada Buddhism (上座部佛教), as well as in the emerging **feudal** nation-states of Myanmar and Thailand on the Indochinese Peninsula (中南半岛) that converted under its influence, **the Muslims were effortlessly repelled by Buddhist feudal lords** (封建领主)! To this day, the Rohingya refugee crisis remains a lingering international issue.

In the north, the Islamic khanates stretching from the Southern Russian steppes to Siberia were swept completely clean by the Russians, who had already completed their **feudalization**. The northern boundary of the Islamic world retreated to the Caucasus.

In Southeastern Europe, even though the Ottoman Turks once penetrated deep into Hungary, when the imperial tide finally receded, the only regions where Islam managed to secure a dominant position were places like Albania and Bosnia and Herzegovina—nations dominated by mountainous terrain and teeming with scattered tribes.

However, in regions that had already formed **feudal nation-states** (封建民族国家) or exhibited obvious signs of **feudalization** at the time of the Turkish conquest (*in fact, one can easily note that the Balkans originally participated in the **feudalization** process brought about by the Eurasian Great Migrations, though it was less smooth than in Western Europe due to prolonged tug-of-war with the Byzantine Empire*)—such as Bulgaria, Serbia, Greece, and further out, Hungary—after achieving independence, their original religions remained completely intact. Conversely, under the prolonged rule of Byzantium—the remnant **classical empire**—the vicinity of Constantinople and the Anatolian region obviously became the solid fundamental base for the Turks.

In the southwest, Ethiopia, which adhered to Oriental Orthodoxy, found itself completely encircled by Muslims by the 14th and 15th centuries. Not only did its coastal regions fall into Muslim hands, but the downstream Nubian region had also been in a disadvantaged position relative to Egypt's Islamic regimes ever since the Muslim conquest of Egypt, eventually allowing Muslims to secure present-day Sudan.

However, starting from the 13th century, Ethiopia embarked on its own **feudalization** process. This Christian enclave was not only not annihilated by enemies from all directions, but even launched highly effective counterattacks against the Muslims, remaining one of the most populous Christian nations to this day.

In regions rapidly conquered during the early Islamic period, such as Iberia and Sicily, the Muslims could not hold onto a single inch of ground. Sicily was snatched away by the **feudalized** Normans. The Christian states in northern Iberia ultimately spent over seven centuries completely expelling the Muslims (*the Reconquista*). During this period, the only force capable of forming a stalemate with Christianity was none other than the Berbers, who were also undergoing their own feudal process. However, the Christian side obviously possessed a more advanced society and could secure massive external assistance, such as the Crusades, ultimately overwhelming their opponents.

In West Africa, Islam indeed achieved overwhelming dominance. But the society there was undoubtedly excessively backward; when Islam was introduced via the trans-Saharan trade routes, **feudal societies** fundamentally did not exist there. East Africa is exactly the same case.

Therefore, we can state with absolute clarity: **Islam is a religion capable of inflicting crushing, devastating blows upon pre-feudalized regions, but is utterly helpless against regions that have already been feudalized.** This has been corroborated by countless historical proofs.

Based on this fact, we can make a reverse deduction: **Islam is a religion exceedingly adapted to the demands of an early feudal society, yet it finds it exceedingly difficult to satisfy the demands raised by a society in the middle or late stages of feudalization transitioning toward the early modern era.**

Is there any other evidence to support this point? The answer is obviously yes.

Within the policies implemented by the Prophet himself during his lifetime—relying on the Quran to "establish laws" and reform the preexisting Arab society—we can find the exact evidence we are looking for. This is concentrated in the systems of **property inheritance** and **marriage**.

Muhammad first established the partial right of individuals to dispose of private property through a will system, negating the clan's ownership of property. Subsequently, he gradually abandoned the convention of distributing inheritance exclusively among paternal clansmen, affirming the inheritance rights of direct blood relatives, including women. The shares of inheritance for the deceased's close relatives in their individual capacities were fixed, and women were also taken into consideration.

Such a **partible inheritance** (析产制) system is undoubtedly one of the characteristics of an early **feudal society** (封建社会), because it reflects the miniaturization of production units (*and social units*).

Regarding the marriage system, the Prophet fiercely condemned the previously loose unions between men and women and the non-exclusivity of partners, aiming to eradicate the "evil deeds" of "falling into adultery." (*I use quotation marks here obviously not to endorse the marriage system of pre-Islamic Arab society, but to state that marriage systems inevitably change with social development. Judging the justice of an institution from a different era using the moral lens of another is clearly irrational*).

Islam demanded the establishment of stable, monogamous households (*or strict patriarchal households*). One of the most striking reforms was mandating an "**Iddah**" (待婚期 / waiting period) for women or widows before they could remarry, purely to determine if they were pregnant. This was obviously designed to indisputably verify the paternity of biological children, ultimately guaranteeing the legitimacy of property inheritance.

Synthesizing these two points, the conclusion practically jumps off the page.

Merely looking at **partible inheritance** regarding property, we can at most determine that this is a social consciousness suitable for a society following the disintegration of large, blood-tie-based extended families. That is to say, while early **feudal societies** indeed practiced partible inheritance, this system of inheritance actually already formed during the **classical period** (古典时代). If we consider that the **classical period** is a transitional phase between a slavery class society and a **feudal** class society, it is not difficult to understand the inevitability of this situation, because a transitional period inevitably possesses characteristics of both its preceding and subsequent stages.

However, a marriage system taking a stable patriarchal family as its cornerstone and objective provides even more explicit proof that this is a social consciousness perfectly suited for early **feudalization**!

If one notes the *Goseibai Shikimoku* (《御成敗式目》 / *Formulary of Adjudications*) from the early Kamakura shogunate, they would undoubtedly have a profoundly deep appreciation of this point.

During Japan's dynastic period (*Heian period*), an amorous, highly liberal sexual culture (好色文化) was exceedingly prevalent. Yet, the emerging samurai (*Buke*) regime had absolutely no desire to continue this ethos, **because stable family relationships are the unshakable bedrock of a feudal system** (封建制度) !

Although the amorous ethos of classical Japan was indeed quite prominent among **classical states** in human history, if we observe China and Rome, it is not difficult to discover that relatively open sexual relations were a universally existing phenomenon in classical societies.

When *feudalization* commenced, social mores noticeably became vastly more conservative. This is exactly what the formation of the feudal ruling order demanded!

Therefore, the early words and deeds of the Prophet, centered around the Quran, serve as highly potent evidence proving that Islam is indeed a religion highly tailored to the exact demands of early *feudalization*.

Not only that, but one can also find evidence in the actions of the ancients.

For instance, it is easy to notice that when Islam spread outward across an "open" world (*here, "open" refers to the geographical dimension*), whenever the "**awaiting *feudalization***" (待封建化 / a term I use to designate subjects generating the need for *feudalization*) barbarians in the frontier regions of the Islamic world converted to Islam and established *feudal states* (封建国家), they frequently hoisted the fundamentalist banner of "purifying Islam and returning to the era of the Prophet!"

Such events are extremely widely distributed across time and space. The earliest example is perhaps the Berbers of Morocco in the 11th century, who launched two monumental holy wars that contained the Christians in Iberia for over a century. A more recent example is the Islamic Jihad movements from the late 18th to the 19th century in the West African Sahel (萨赫勒带), spearheaded primarily by the Fulani people (富拉尼人). Its scope stretched from Senegambia eastward to the Lake Chad region, entirely transforming the political landscape of West Africa, and leaving terrifying remnants today, such as the terrorist organization Boko Haram.

We might as well ponder: *Why did these leaders of entirely different ethnicities, spanning such massive spatial and temporal distances, simultaneously choose the exact same fundamentalist slogan of "purifying Islam"?*

I believe the matter should be explained as follows: Although Islam's relatively strict doctrines might, in a certain sense, have dragged down Islamic society from further developing past its early feudal state—for example, scholars often point to its **partible inheritance** (析产制)—it perfectly suited their initial needs. When a society advances to the High Middle Ages, it is glaringly obvious that the *concentrated* inheritance of wealth (长子继承制 / primogeniture) is far more advantageous for the intergenerational transmission and expansion of capital, ultimately facilitating expanded societal investment in arts, sciences, and technology.

However, because Islamic society venerates the Quran as its absolute scripture, fundamentalists possess an innate moral high ground. This makes it exceedingly difficult to adapt the property inheritance system to changing times, which undeniably serves as a colossal roadblock to social development.

But this absolutely does not imply that Islam is monolithically immutable! If it were completely incapable of adapting to social changes, there is no logical reason it would not have been eliminated by society, rather than still boasting over two billion adherents distributed across such vast territories today.

We can easily cite examples of Islam adapting to the shifting tides of the times. For instance, **Mu'tazilism** (穆尔太齐赖派), which flourished during the Arab Empire—the continuation period of *classical society* (古典社会)—was an Islamic sect that upheld the doctrine of free will, massively

absorbed ancient Greek philosophical thought, and leaned heavily toward rationalism. It elevated Islam from a simple faith into an unfathomably profound philosophy.

Today, we can easily point out that such ideology—emphasizing free will, logic, and rationality, and armed with complex philosophical frameworks—was indeed exceptionally suited for the governance of a **classical state**! This has been corroborated in the earlier histories of **classical states**, and it is no wonder Caliph al-Ma'mun (哈里发马蒙) so heavily favored this sect.

However, as **feudalization** developed, such ideology was not only no longer needed for governance, but indeed fundamentally ceased to fit the social landscape. Consequently, starting from the latter half of the 9th century, this sect rapidly declined, ultimately leaving practically no significant influence.

If Mu'tazilism is the evidence on the Muslim timeline corresponding to the **classical period**, then Al-Ghazali's efforts to fuse Sufism with orthodox theology are clearly potent evidence for the **Chūsei** (中世 / feudal Middle Ages) period.

If we observe the modern and contemporary eras, the evidence is equally abundant. The most typical example (*which I am also relatively familiar with*) is none other than Iran, which gradually slid into a theocracy. During the chaotic centuries of warfare and the 18th/19th-century Qajar rule, the clerics of the "**Twelvers**" significantly adjusted their original doctrines in order to prepare to physically take over the state apparatus!

The most representative event of this was the total victory of **Usulism** (乌苏尔派). The Usulis fiercely championed the right of a **Mujtahid** (穆智台希德 / an authoritative expounder of Islamic law) to exercise **Ijtihad** (伊智提哈德 / independent reasoning or the creation of legal interpretation). They argued that *every* generation required a *living* authority on legal interpretation (*which, naturally, meant high-ranking Shiite clerics like Khomeini*) to interpret religious law and develop its practical applications.

Those relatively familiar with the politics of the Islamic Republic of Iran can visibly see today's Grand Ayatollahs exercising precisely such astronomical power; at times, looking at it from the perspective of an outsider, it even feels bizarre. For example, during significant moments (*like military parades*), Iranians will display massive portraits of Khomeini and Khamenei. Although everyone knows this custom was pilfered from the so-called communist revolutions of the last century, and Iranian officials will naturally claim these portraits are not displayed for the purpose of "worship," the fact that this occurs in a theocratic state whose state religion—Islam—explicitly and strictly prohibits idolatry, is somewhat darkly comical!

However, we can indeed effortlessly understand why the Usuli sect emerged victorious: **Because the grassroots power of Iran had collapsed at the time, and the only force capable of filling that power vacuum was inevitably the clerical stratum.** Therefore, changes in religious doctrine *had* to occur to fling the doors wide open for the "Twelver" clerics to plunge deeply into direct political rule!

Therefore, we can assert that although Islam possesses inherently conservative characteristics, it obviously wields no immutable, eternal divine power; it is fundamentally impossible for society to change while religious doctrines remain unaltered by a single word.

Understanding this, if we place ourselves in the shoes of those Islamic rulers who needed to spearhead the **feudalization** process of their own nations, how would they view the current situation?

The landscape they observed must have been this: The development of Islam in different regions inevitably led to changes in doctrines and religious organizations. Because in regions that had already been **feudalized**, no matter how sluggish the pace, some degree of progress would ultimately occur; the local Islam there might have already diverged from the Islam that served the *early stages of feudalization*.

These newly emerging rulers would likely lament: *"Islam is indeed excellent, but the 'current' Islam is too advanced for my people. Returning to the era of the Prophet is the absolute best option!"*

Consequently, newly converted regimes possessing an intense need for **feudalization** inevitably pursued fundamentalist Islam to achieve conquest and rule. In this process, they formed enmities with pagans and heretics, further stimulating the zealotry of holy wars (Jihad).

However, an unfortunate tragedy we can observe is that the geographical position of the Islamic world is excessively open. Along its sprawling peripheries, newly emerging nations undergoing **feudalization** continuously joined the great Muslim community. Even within the internal mountainous regions of the Islamic world, a few tribes could suddenly emerge and launch a **"feudal conquest."**

Although this unbroken chain of political movements spanning ten centuries massively expanded Islam's dominions—forging the world's second-largest (and potentially the future largest) global religion—on the flip side, the fundamentalist demands of these newly emerging nations, both inside and outside the Islamic society, **significantly retarded the progressive evolution of Islam itself alongside the shifting times.**

Two factors further amplified this negative impact: First, Islam demands taking the Quran as the ultimate guide, which grants fundamentalists a natural, innate moral superiority within Islamic society. Second, Islam mandates that every Muslim, if conditions permit, must undertake the pilgrimage to Mecca (the *Hajj* / 麦加朝觐) at least once. This measure, originally designed to solidify the cohesion of believers, later mutated into a massive catalyst for the proliferation of fundamentalism!

Because Muslims from societies at vastly different stages of development all converged in Mecca, the voices of fundamentalists were drastically amplified. If we observe the modern history of Islam (the 18th and 19th centuries), this phenomenon is absolutely impossible to ignore.

Thus, we now have ample reason to prove that **Islam is indeed a religion exceptionally suited for societies in the early stages of feudalization, yet inherently maladapted to the further development of the feudalization process.**

Simultaneously, we have pinpointed the root causes behind the generation of holy wars, as well as the societal roots explaining why the Islamic world devolved into backwardness (*though, inevitably, there are naturally other contributing factors*).

Moreover, I believe the attempt made in this section—**reinterpreting the propagative capacity of a religion as its adaptive capacity for social organization**—will prove immensely beneficial for all subsequent research!

4，伊斯兰教是非常适合早期封建社会的宗教

在当今互联网上，伊斯兰教常常被描述为一种侵略性极强的宗教而引发很多人的担忧，这种观点确实反映了一种历史事实，但是却掩盖了另一种更为重要的历史事实。伊斯兰教扩张的能力强大吗，毫无疑问是的，从塞内冈比亚直到东印度群岛，一种宗教在 1000 多年里，征服了如此广大的地域，甚至大幅击退了基督教和佛教的势力范围，这样的成功无疑会令任何观察者印象深刻。可是另一方面我们更应该注意到的是，伊斯兰教的扩张有着极为清楚的“界限”，那就是这个宗教从来只能够征服前封建化地区的社会，而对于已经封建化的社会无能为力。如果我们仔细罗列伊斯兰教所征服的敌人，就很容易注意到他们无非属于前国家时期的蛮荒之地，早期（奴隶制）国家或者古典帝国，而面对真正封建化的敌人，伊斯兰教不要说能够战而胜之甚至会被大幅度地击退。

首先观察伊斯兰版图的东北方，在穆斯林征服中亚的同时，现在中国新疆地区还处于唐帝国这个复辟官僚国家的控制下，新疆地区的城邦国家距离封建化相去甚远，伊斯兰教征服了这里今天，并且在元朝大大渗入中国内地。但是随着蒙古接纳藏传佛教信仰并初步封建化，到 17 世纪新疆地区的伊斯兰势力甚至被信奉藏传佛教的准噶尔汗国压倒了，反倒是大清皇帝最终搬掉了压在新疆穆斯林头上的这座大山。即使就是遭到了这样的迟滞，整个明清时期中国西北地区的伊斯兰化都堪称严重。在伊斯兰版图的北方，欧亚大草原中西部的伊斯兰汗国随着完成封建化的俄国的扩张被大幅击退到了高加索地区，而南俄草原直到黑海之滨的伊斯兰国家不复存在。

在印度斯坦，伊斯兰教政权的确曾经近乎控制了整个次大陆，但是现如今的版图却非常有趣，巴基斯坦所处的印度河流域与亚非伊斯兰世界的主要环境颇为相似，这种以大河灌溉农业为基石的热带沙漠气候确实难以封建化，突厥穆斯林入侵这里的时候当地确实处于前封建化的状态。当古尔王朝第一次进攻到现今孟加拉国领土范围的时候，这里还属于印度的“边地”，相对于已经开发充分的恒河流域大部可谓汪洋泽国。（这样说可能太过分，不过孟加拉地区，包括东西孟加拉，的历史进程的确要比恒河平原晚几个世纪，因此社会相对落后是正常的，后面还会再提到这里）穆斯林刚刚抵达克什米尔的时候，统治青藏高原的吐蕃帝国瓦解才不久，但是随着青藏高原的封建化，伊斯兰教无法再东进高原半寸。喜马拉雅山南麓的尼泊尔沙阿王朝的统治者最初就是北印度不愿意屈服于伊斯兰教的印度教徒，他们显然在这个正在经历封建时期的山地国家建立了钢铁般的防御阵线，穆斯林一步也没有踏足这里。突厥人进入北印度时，北印度的封建化虽然应该已经开始，但是程度却很低，穆斯林得以很快扫荡这里。但是与此同时，南印度的封建进程仍在进行，一大批林立的印度教封建王国甚至毗奢耶那伽罗这样的帝国，毫无疑问，等穆斯林统治者把目光投向南方的时候，他们发现要想征服这里实在难于登天，无论是德里苏丹还是莫卧儿皇帝都没办法彻底解决次大陆南端的抵抗。

如果说在政治上具有对北印度的独立性是地缘原因在其主要作用，那么显然在宗教上仍然进行如此激烈的抵抗起主导作用的必然是社会存在了，因为人们很容易注意到以北印度为统治中心的政权一样难以管理孟加拉，但是这不妨碍孟加拉国哪怕独立了仍然以伊斯兰国家的面目存在。甚至于在北印度的封建进程进一步发展之后，穆斯林在北印度的统治也遭到了强力挑战，最典型的例子就是旁遮普的锡克教徒，穆斯林对他们的圣战以惨败告终，到现在南北印度统一在一个政权下，仍然是印度教为主体的地区大国。

在更加东南的地方情况是一样的，马尔代夫，马来亚和东印度群岛分布着前国家政权，早期奴隶制国家以及像满者伯夷这样具有古典性质的帝国，他们没有一点悬念便被伊斯兰教征服了，在爪哇岛伊斯兰教的扩张甚至是以地方率先伊斯兰教然后掀起毁灭性的叛乱实现的。然而在南传上座部佛教的斯里兰卡，以及受到其影响而改宗的中南半岛新兴封建民族国家缅甸和泰国，穆斯林被信仰佛教的封建领主轻而易举地击退了，到现在罗兴亚人难民甚至是一个国际问题。

在北部，从南俄草原到西伯利亚的伊斯兰汗国被已经完成封建化的俄国人一扫而空，伊斯兰世界的北部边界退缩到高加索一带。在东南欧，哪怕奥斯曼土耳其人曾经深入匈牙利，但是当大潮退去，伊斯兰教所能取得一定优势的地区，无非是阿尔巴尼亚和波黑这样山地地貌为主体，存在大量分散部落的国家。而在被土耳其人征服时已经形成封建民族国家或者封建化比较明显的区域（实际上人们很容易注意到巴尔干地区原本就参与了欧亚民族大迁徙所带来的封建化进程，只不过因为长期和拜占庭帝国拉锯没有西欧那般顺利），例如保加利亚，塞尔维亚，希腊以及更远的匈牙利独立之后原本该是什么宗教还是什么宗教。而在拜占庭这个残存的古典帝国长期统治下君士坦丁堡附近以及安纳托利亚地区显然已经是土耳其人稳固的基本盘。

在西南方，信仰东方派正教的埃塞俄比亚到 14，15 世纪时已经处于穆斯林的全面包围之中，沿海地区落入了穆斯林手中不说，下游的努比亚地区自从穆斯林征服埃及以来就较埃及的伊斯兰政权处于弱势，穆斯林最终取得了现在的苏丹。但是从 13 世纪开始，埃塞俄比亚自身也走上了封建化进程，这个基督教的飞地非但没有被四面八方的敌人消灭甚至对穆斯林展开了有效的还击，到今天仍是人口最多的几个基督教国家之一。在伊比利亚和西西里这样在伊斯兰早期迅速征服的地区穆斯林一个也守不住，西西里被封建化的诺曼人夺去，伊比利亚北部的基督教国家最终经历七个多世纪完全驱逐了穆斯林，这期间唯一能与基督教形成对峙的不是别人而是同样经历封建进程的柏柏尔人，不过基督徒一方显然社会更加先进，而且还可以获得十字军这样大规模的外援，最终压倒了对手。在西非伊斯兰教确实取得了压倒性的优势，但是这里的社会无疑过于落后，在伊斯兰教通过跨撒哈拉贸易传入之时根本就不存在封建社会，东非也是一样的例子。

因此我们可以非常明确地讲，伊斯兰教是一种能对前封建化地区予以摧枯拉朽的打击，但是对业已封建化的地区完全束手无策的宗教，这被无数的历史证据所证实。因此我们能够根据这个事实做出一种反向推断，伊斯兰教是一种极为适应封建化早期社会需求的宗教，但是对于封建化中期以及晚期向近世社会过渡时期的社会所提出的需求则难以满足。

对于这一点是否还有其他证据？回答显然是有的，在先知本人在世时依托《古兰经》“立法度”对原有的阿拉伯社会进行改革的一些政策中就有我们想找到的证据，这集中在财产继承和婚姻制度上。穆罕默德首先通过遗嘱制度确立个人支配私有财产的部分权利，否定氏族的财产所有权，继而逐步放弃父系宗亲分配遗产的惯例，肯定包括女性在内的直系血亲的继承权。死者近亲以个人身份继承遗产的份额被固定下来，女性也被考虑在内。像这样析产的遗产继承制度无疑是与封建化早期社会的特征之一，因为它反映生产单位（以及社会单位）的小型化。在婚姻制度上，先知严厉谴责了此前男女的松散结合和伴侣的非独占性，意在消灭“陷入奸淫”的“恶行”（我在这里打引号显然不是认可先知之前阿拉伯社会的婚姻制度，而是说婚姻制度是必然社会发展而改变，用一个时代的眼光审视一个不同时代的制度是否正义显然具有不合理性）。伊斯兰教要求建立稳固的一夫制家庭，最引人注目的一项改革是规定妇女或寡妇改嫁前的“待婚期”来确定是否有孕，这显然是为了辨明亲生子女的身份是否无疑，最终保证财产继承的合法性。

综合这两点来看，结论是呼之欲出的。单从财产继承上的析产制来看，我们最多能够判断这是一种适合于以血缘为纽带的大家族解体后的社会意识。这也就是说，封建早期的社会固然是析产的，但是继承上的析产制在古典时期就已经形成了。如果我们考虑到古典时期是奴隶制阶级社会和封建制阶级社会的过渡时期就完全不难理解这种形势的必然性，因为过渡时期必然同时具有其前一个阶段与其后一个阶段的特征。然而对于稳固的父系家庭为基石和目标的婚姻制度就更加明确地证明这是一种适合封建早期的社会意识了。如果人们注意到镰仓幕府早期的《御成败式目》想必会对此具有极为深刻的体会，王朝时期（平安时期）的日本好色文化是极为盛行的，但是新兴武家政权并不希望延续这种风气，因为稳定的家

庭关系是封建制度的牢固基石。虽然古典日本的好色之风。在人类历史上的各个古典国家中确实较为突出，但是如果我们观察中国和罗马，就不难发现较为开放的性关系是一种在古典社会普遍存在的现象。当封建化开始的时候，社会风气明显变得保守起来，这恰恰是封建统治秩序形成的需要。因此以《古兰经》为核心的先知早期言行能够较为有力地证明伊斯兰教的确是一种高度合乎早期封建化需求的宗教。

不仅如此，人们还能从古人的行动上找到依据。例如我们很容易注意到，当伊斯兰教在一个开放的世界（这里的开放指的是地理层面）向外传播，伊斯兰世界边疆地区的“待封建化”（这个词用以指产生封建化需要的对象）的蛮族在皈依伊斯兰教并建立封建国家时，往往会打出纯洁伊斯兰教，回到先知时代这样的原教旨主义的口号。这样的事情在时空上分布极为广泛，最早的例子恐怕是公元 11 世纪摩洛哥的柏柏尔人，他们用两次气势恢宏的圣战将基督徒在伊比利亚遏制了一个多世纪。而最近的例子则是 18 世纪末到 19 世纪，西非萨赫勒带（Sahel）以富拉尼人为主力的伊斯兰圣战运动，其范围从塞内冈比亚向东延伸到乍得湖地区，改变了西非的政治面貌，甚至今天还有“博科圣地”这样的恐怖组织存留。

我们不妨思考一下，为什么这些不同民族的领袖，在时空跨度如此之大的位置同时选择了纯洁伊斯兰教这样带有原教旨主义色彩的口号？我认为事情应该这样解释，虽然伊斯兰教较为严格的教义在某种意义上可能拖累伊斯兰社会由封建化早期的状态进一步发展，例如学者们往往能够注意到的一点是析产的继承制。当社会发展到中世纪盛期的时候，显然财产的集中继承对于财富在代际之间的传递并扩大是有利的，并最终有利于社会文艺和技术投资的扩大。然而伊斯兰社会奉《古兰经》为经典，这使得原教旨主义者在道德上有一种天然的优势，想要顺应时势改变财产继承制就比较困难，这显然对于社会的发展是阻碍。

但是这绝对不意味着伊斯兰教是一成不变的，如果他完全不能够适应社会变化，那么没有道理其不被社会淘汰，反倒至今仍有 20 多亿信众分布在如此广大的地区。我们同样可以举出伊斯兰教顺应时事变化的例子，比如在阿拉伯帝国这一古典社会的延续时期兴盛一时的穆尔太齐赖派（Mu'tazilism）就是一种秉持意志自由论的，大量吸收古希腊哲学思想的，带有唯理主义倾向的伊斯兰教派别，它让伊斯兰教从一种简单的信仰变为极为深奥的哲学。我们现在很容易指出，这种强调意志自由，逻辑和理性的带有复杂哲学观点的思想的确非常适合古典国家的统治，这一点在更早期的古典国家历史上得到了印证，也无怪乎哈里发马蒙（al-Ma'mun）如此青睐该派。但是随着封建化的发展，这样的思想不但在统治上不被需要，而且的确不再适合社会形势，因此该派别从九世纪后半叶开始迅速衰退，到后来已经基本不造成重要影响。

如果说这是穆斯林时间表上古典时期的一个证据，那么安萨里将苏菲主义与正统学派融合的努力显然是中世时期的有力证据。我们观察近现代的情况证据同样很多，最为典型的（当然这也是因为我比较熟悉）莫过于逐渐滑向神权制的伊朗，在战乱期间和恺加王朝统治的 18、19 世纪，十二伊玛目派教士为了做好接管国家政权的准备很大程度上调整了原有的教义，特别有代表性的事件是乌苏尔派（Usulism，也翻译成乌苏勒派）的全面胜利。乌苏尔派极力鼓吹穆智台希德（Mujtahid，教法权威的阐述人）运用伊智提哈德（Ijtihad，意思是创制）的权力，认为每一代人都需要活着的教法阐释权威（这当然就是霍梅尼这样的高级什叶派教士）解释教法并发展教法的实际应用。对于伊朗伊斯兰共和国的政治较为了解的人们可以显而易见地看到今天的大阿亚图拉的确在行使如此巨大的权力，有的时候甚至站在旁观者的角度都会感到奇怪。例如伊朗人在重要时刻（比方说阅兵）会把霍梅尼和哈梅内伊的画像摆出来，虽然人人都知道这种习惯来自上个世纪的所谓共产主义革命，伊朗官方当然也会宣称这些画像并非出于崇拜的目的而出现，但是这发生在以伊斯兰教这一明令禁止偶像崇拜的宗教为国教的神权国家还是令人多少有点哭笑不得。然而我们的确很容易理解为什么乌苏尔派能够取胜，因为当年伊朗的基层权力已经出现了崩溃的情况，而能够填补这种权力空白的必然是教士阶层，因此宗教教义的变化就一定会为十二伊玛目派教士深度参与政治大开方便之门。

因此我们可以说伊斯兰教虽然有固有的保守特征，但是显然也没有什么万世不易的神力，不可能说社会在变化而教义一字不更。如果理解了这一点，我们站在那些面临需要领导本民族封建化进程的伊斯兰教统治者的立场上会怎么看待现在的局势呢？他们所看到的局面必然是，伊斯兰教所在不同地区的发展必然导致教义和宗教组织发生了变化，因为已经封建化的地区，无论再怎么迟缓总归还是会有所进步，当地的伊斯兰教可能已经与为封建化早期社会服务的伊斯兰教有了区别。我们大概也会发出这样的感慨：伊斯兰教的确很好，但是现在的伊斯兰教对我的人民来说太先进了，回到先知的年代是最好的。于是乎新皈依的具有强烈封建化需求的政权就必然追求原教旨的伊斯兰教以实现征服和统治，并且在这一过程中与异教和异端形成敌对，进一步刺激了圣战的狂热。然而我们能够看到的一个不幸之处是，伊斯兰世界所处的地理位置太过开放，在其漫长的边缘不断有新兴的正在封建化的民族加入穆斯林这个大团体，即使是伊斯兰世界的内部山区也同样会突然出现几个部落开始“封建征服”。这种在十个世纪中从未间断的政治运动虽然在一方面大大地扩张了伊斯兰教的统治区，造就了这一世界第二大的，未来在人数上可能跃居第一大的世界性宗教。但是在另一方面伊斯兰社会内外新兴民族的原教旨主义诉求又会显著地拖慢伊斯兰教本身随时代发展的进步。两个因素进一步放大了这种消极影响，首先是伊斯兰教要求以《古兰经》为根本指南，这使得原教旨主义者在伊斯兰社会有天然的道德优越性；其次是伊斯兰教要求每一个穆斯林在有条件的情况下都要去麦加朝觐一次，这种最初为了巩固教徒凝聚力的措施在后来却成为了原教旨主义扩散的重要原因，因为全世界处于不同发展阶段社会的穆斯林都要到麦加去，而原教旨主义者的声音就会被放大，如果我们观察伊斯兰教在近代的历史（18、19 世纪）就绝对不会忽略这种现象了。

就这样，我们已经有充足的理由证明伊斯兰教的确是一个非常适合封建化早期社会但是却不适应封建化进程进一步发展的宗教，同时我们也找到了圣战产生的原因以及伊斯兰世界变为落后的社会根源（当然必然还有其他原因就是了）。而且我认为，这一节中把宗教传播能力重新解释为一种社会组织适配能力的尝试，对于之后的研究是非常有益的。